

CSW Agent — Tanium Deployment Checklist

One-page field guide for deployment teams

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Repo: github.com/chandrapati/CSW-Agent-Installation-Guide · **Full runbook:** [tanium/README.md](#)

Critical rule

Write `user.cfg` with the activation key in the install directory *before* Tanium runs any install command. Without it, the agent may install but stay *Not Active / unauthorized* in the CSW UI.

ACTIVATION_KEY=<from CSW UI → Manage → Agents → Install Agent>
HTTPS_PROXY=<http://proxy.example.com:8080> # optional

Pre-flight (CSW admin)

Step	Done
Confirm target tenant , scope , OS , and sensor type (Visibility vs Enforcement)	☐
Open Manage → Agents → Install Agent ; copy activation key (treat as secret)	☐
Download installer bundle or script for the same choices	☐
Confirm outbound 443/TCP (and on-prem collector/enforcer ports if applicable)	☐
Configure EDR/AV exclusions on endpoints before deploy	☐
Store activation key in Tanium package variable (not plain-text Git)	☐

Package contents (same folder on every endpoint)

File	Required
user.cfg (with ACTIVATION_KEY pre-staged)	Yes
ca.cert	Yes
site.cfg	Yes
sensor_config	Yes
sensor_type	Yes
enforcer.cfg	If enforcement
TetrationAgentInstaller.msi (Windows) or .rpm/.deb/.sh (Linux)	Yes

Suggested paths: Linux /opt/tanium/csw/ · Windows C:\Program Files\Tanium\csw\

Tanium Deploy package steps (order matters)

#	Package step	Done
1	Stage user.cfg — run stage-user-cfg script with CSW_ACTIVATION_KEY from Tanium variable	☐
2	Deploy full Cisco bundle (site files + installer) to install directory	☐
3	Install — Linux: tanium-linux-install.sh · Windows: tanium-windows-install.ps1	☐
4	Success criteria: exit code 0 + service Running (csw-agent / CswAgent)	☐
5	Pilot wave → production waves; confirm CSW UI shows host Running within 1–2 min	☐

Post-deploy verification

Check	Linux	Windows
Service running	<code>systemctl is-active csw-agent</code>	<code>Get-Service CswAgent</code>
CSW UI	<i>Manage</i> → <i>Agents</i> → <i>Software Agents</i> — status Running , correct scope	Same

If something fails

All platforms (Tanium)

Symptom	First action
<i>Not Active / unauthorized</i>	Confirm <code>user.cfg</code> with valid <code>ACTIVATION_KEY</code> existed before install step ran
Package step order wrong	Rebuild package: (1) stage user.cfg → (2) deploy bundle → (3) install
Key in Tanium variable empty	Fix secret variable binding; pilot on one host before fleet

Linux

Symptom	First action
Install fails immediately	<code>journalctl -u csw-agent -n 50</code> ; confirm <code>user.cfg</code> at <code>/opt/tanium/csw/</code>
TLS / cert errors	Re-ship <code>ca.cert</code> + full bundle from CSW UI
Service won't start	Check kernel-devel match: <code>uname -r</code> ; check SELinux AVC denials
Network timeout	<code>nc -zv <cluster> 443</code> ; open firewall per network prereq doc

Windows

Symptom	First action
MSI failure	Open <code>%TEMP%\csw-agent-tanium-install.log</code> ; search <code>Return value 3</code>
Service not running	<code>Get-Service CswAgent</code> ; check Application event log
EDR block (1722 / 1603)	Add Defender exclusions before

Symptom	First action
	redeploy
Network	Test-NetConnection <cluster> -Port 443; add HTTPS_PROXY to user.cfg if proxied
Full troubleshooting: tanium/README.md · operations/06-troubleshooting.md	

Draft v1 — cross-check against the Cisco Secure Workload User Guide for your release before production use.